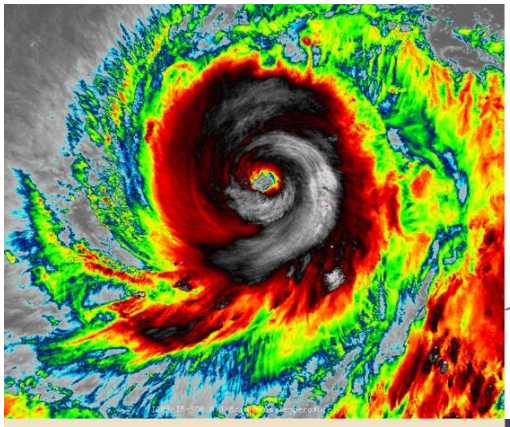
Before the Typhoon: Preparation Is Survival













Objectives:

After completing this chapter, you will be able to:

- ✧ Prepare their home before a typhoon.
- ✧ Pack a 72-hour emergency “Go-Bag.”
- ✧ Protect important documents.
- ✧ Plan and practice family evacuation.
- ✧ Coordinate with the community for safety.

Before the Typhoon: Preparation Is Survival

Mastering what to do before typhoon season hits isn't just advice—it's your family's lifeline. When PAGASA issues Signal 1 (winds 30–60 km/h), act immediately with these proactive steps:

1. **Fortify Your Home**



- ✧ **Reinforce Weak Points:** Board windows with 1.9 cm-thick plywood cut to size. Secure G.I. roofing with hurricane straps or #12 gauge steel wires. Replace damaged capiz panels with storm shutters.

- ✧ **Prevent Flooding**: Clear storm drains of leaves/plastic waste. Place sandbags wrapped in plastic (sako bags) at doorways—layer them brick-style for maximum sealing.

- ✧ **Anchor Outdoor Items**: Move potted plants, banggeras (drying racks), and furniture indoors. Chain down water tanks and generators to concrete slabs. Trim trees within 10 meters of your house—overhanging branches become deadly projectiles.

2. Build a 72-Hour "Go-Bag" (Per Person).

Item	Quantity	Critical Notes
Water	12 liters	Store in BPA-free containers.
Ready-to-eat food	9 meals	Adobo, pancit, and energy bars (no cooking required)
Medicines	7-day supply	Include antihistamines, insulin, and asthma inhalers.
Hygiene kit	1 set	Alcohol, sanitary pads, diapers, soap
N95 masks	3+	Filter toxins from post-typhoon debris.

3. Secure Vital Documents

- ✧ Place land titles, birth certificates, and insurance papers in triple-layer protection:
- ✧ Ziplock bag
- ✧ Waterproof hard case
- ✧ Fireproof safe bolted to the floor
- ✧ **Digitize documents:** Use Google Drive or Barangay Cloud portals. Share access with 2 trusted relatives.

4. Drill Your Evacuation Plan

Map Routes: Identify two paths to evacuation centers (schools/gyms). Avoid flood-prone roads like EDSA or C5.



Assign Roles:

- ✧ **Parent 1**: Carry emergency kit
- ✧ **Parent 2**: Secure pets in carriers
- ✧ **Children**: Wear whistles & ID tags
- ✧ **Practice**: Run timed drills monthly. Target <10 minutes for full evacuation.

5. Community Coordination



- ✧ Join Barangay DRRM WhatsApp groups for real-time alerts.
- ✧ Pre-identify neighbors needing aid (elderly/disabled).
- ✧ **Stock communal tools:** ropes, bolt cutters, and life vests.

Why This Works: Typhoon Haiyan (2013) proved prepared communities reduce fatalities by 71%. When Tacloban's Brgy. 88 conducted drills; 98% survived storm surges.

Video Links;

How to prepare for a typhoon

https://youtu.be/KDZ_AfZ1HwA?si=sgtz4iTrfcZKpSmI

Bagyo o Tropical Cyclones | Disaster Preparedness

https://youtu.be/7WxUgGfiHb4?si=XjgdMbJtR5Hpd7_J

Reference:

EcoFlow

https://www.ecoflow.com/ph/blog/what-to-do-before-during-and-after-a-typhoon